“A good Christian never gets angry.”

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Where it often comes from

Many of us learned that anger is always sinful, that nice people never show it, and that Christians should be calm. Where anger was explosive in the home, we may fear it in ourselves. So we bury it, and it comes out as sarcasm, withdrawal, headaches, or a sudden blowup.

What Scripture teaches

Paul says, “Be angry, yet do not sin. Do not let the sun set upon your anger,” which assumes anger is not itself sin. The psalmist says, “Be angry, yet do not sin; on your bed, search your heart and be still.” Jesus “looked around at them with anger and sorrow at their hardness of heart,” and He made a whip and drove the money changers out of the temple. James says, “Everyone should be quick to listen, slow to speak, and slow to anger, for man’s anger does not bring about the righteousness that God desires.” Proverbs says, “A gentle answer turns away wrath.” Anger is a signal. What we do with it matters.

> *“‘Be angry, yet do not sin.’ Do not let the sun set upon your anger, and do not give the devil a foothold”* (Ephesians 4:26–27).

Also see

> “Be angry, yet do not sin; on your bed, search your heart and be still” (Psalm 4:4).

> “Jesus looked around at them with anger and sorrow at their hardness of heart. Then He said to the man, ‘Stretch out your hand.’ So he stretched it out, and it was restored” (Mark 3:5).

> “My beloved brothers, understand this: Everyone should be quick to listen, slow to speak, and slow to anger, for man’s anger does not bring about the righteousness that God desires” (James 1:19–20).

> “A gentle answer turns away wrath, but a harsh word stirs up anger” (Proverbs 15:1).

Common self-statements

- Angry feelings mean I am a bad Christian.
- I should never feel this way.
- Good people stay calm.
- If I get angry, I am sinning.
- I have to bury my anger.
- Anger is always wrong.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing anger is either absent or sinful.
- Should statements: Insisting that I should never feel anger.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling guilty about anger and concluding that I am bad.
- Suppression: Burying anger, which then leaks out sideways.

Challenging questions

- What was I taught about anger, and by whom?

- What does my anger tell me about what I value or what hurt me?
- Did Jesus ever express anger? What was its source and its limit?
- What are healthy ways to express anger?
- What happens when I bury it?
- What can I do tonight to search my heart and be still?

Truth summary

> Anger itself is not a sin. It is a signal that something matters to me or has hurt me. I can bring it to God, express it respectfully, and not let it control me. Jesus felt anger too, and He never sinned.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Anger
- Communication
- Impatient
- Peace
- Forgiveness

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Anger
- Communication

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Voice of Truth — Casting Crowns
Test accusing or frightening messages against God's truth.

Battle Belongs — Phil Wickham
Bring fear and uncertainty to God rather than carrying the outcome alone.

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

My Plan for Replacing "A good Christian never gets angry"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"A good Christian never gets angry." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What was I taught about anger?
- ☐ What is my anger telling me?
- ☐ How did Jesus express anger?
- ☐ What healthy outlets do I have?
- ☐ What happens when I bury it?
- ☐ Whom can I talk with?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Be angry, yet do not sin.
- ☐ Jesus felt anger.
- ☐ Anger is a signal.
- ☐ I can bring anger to God.
- ☐ A gentle answer turns away wrath.
- ☐ I can express anger without harming.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Ephesians 4:26–27**
  "'Be angry, yet do not sin.' Do not let the sun set upon your anger, and do not give the devil a foothold."
- ☐ **Psalm 4:4**
  "Be angry, yet do not sin; on your bed, search your heart and be still."
- ☐ **Proverbs 15:1**
  "A gentle answer turns away wrath, but a harsh word stirs up anger."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Anger as a signal: Each time you feel anger, write what hurt or mattered, and one healthy response.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, Ephesians 4:26–27 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I can be angry without sinning when I bring it to God.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Anger" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- ☐ Name the anger. Write what you are angry about and what it protects.
- ☐ Bring it to God. Pray it out honestly, using the psalms as a model.
- ☐ Take a pause. Walk, breathe, or journal before responding.
- ☐ Speak calmly. Share your concern respectfully with the person involved.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "A good Christian never gets angry": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Anger named
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~A good Christian never gets angry.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I have been afraid of my anger. Help me hear what it is telling me, bring it to You honestly, and respond in ways that heal rather than harm. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.